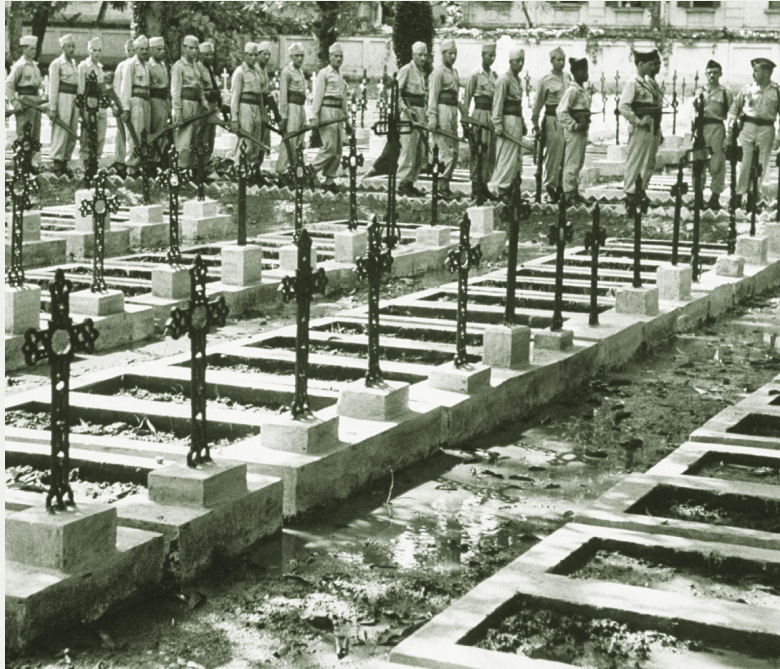


» AFTER

The withdrawal of French troops, completed in 1956, ended the colonial era in Indochina and left Vietnam partitioned.

NORTH AND SOUTH

A **communist government** led by Ho Chi Minh took power north of the 17th parallel. The South became the **American-backed Republic of Vietnam** under Ngo Dinh Diem, who became president in 1955 after defeating Bao Dai in a government-controlled referendum. The **nationwide elections** called for by the Geneva Accords and intended to create a democratic unified Vietnam never took place.



FRENCH TROOPS PAY THEIR RESPECTS TO FALLEN COMRADES IN INDOCHINA